

Instructions and template for annual reports on activities with framework contracts

The purpose and structure of annual reports

All administrative bodies whose activities are funded by the Nordic Council of Ministers by way of a framework contract must submit an annual report to the Nordic Council of Ministers by 15 February. The annual report must contain an income statement for the previous year's activities, and a statement on the utilisation of the funds provided by the Nordic Council of Ministers.

The purpose of the annual report is to demonstrate what activities have been carried out as described in and funded in accordance with the framework contract. This is an important tool for the responsible advisor in the performance of their duties in respect of the committees of senior officials and the councils of ministers. However, the annual report is also a central element for the work of the Nordic Committee for Co-operation, the Nordic Council of Ministers for Nordic Co-operation, and the Danish National Audit Office in reviewing, following up on, and controlling the component of the Nordic budget for the funding of activities with framework contracts.

This annual report template has been drafted to make the annual report as clear and uniform as possible for all the users mentioned above. For this purpose, the income statement of the annual report is separated into an activity section and a financial section.

The activity section of the annual report

The activity section serves as a comparison with the budget and project description submitted as an appendix to the framework contract for the current financial year. This means that the description in the table may vary between different activities depending on the individual project description. This provides an opportunity to adapt the template's appearance to some extent to cater for follow-up and control requirements. For example, it is possible to use just one table for the entire report in respect of the activity section. However, two or more tables can be used, as in the template. The crucial thing is that the annual report reflects what is described in the contract and contract documents (project description and budget) in terms of both content and level of detail, and that all sections (objectives, results, budget, utilisation, and comments on any deviations in relation to the budget) are included. In addition, a brief report must be included on how the activities have contributed to *Our Vision 2030* and other

cross-sectoral Nordic strategies.

The financial section of the annual report

Administrative expenses must be reported separately in the first table of the financial statement. "Administrative expenses" refers to all expenses for the operation and administrative functions of the activities, i.e. all expenses not directly linked to a specific activity or project.

The financial statement's second table for unspent funds provides a summary of how much of the funds granted by the Nordic Council of Ministers has not been spent in relation to the budget. The table covers three years as funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers may be used over a maximum of three years under the financial regulations.

Under the contract, the administrative body may, as a rule, carry unspent funds forwards for use during the next contract year. The administrative body has an obligation to ensure that the obsolescence rule is taken into account. This applies also to underlying allocations where a project or activity is managed by an external party that has received a share of the funding from the Nordic Council of Ministers. However, the guideline is to set as precise a budget as possible and to plan activities so that the budget is used during the contract year. The purpose of the table is, therefore, to show how much of the funds allocated for the year were not spent in accordance with the budget.

Other

If the contribution from the Nordic Council of Ministers exceeds DKK 200,000 and the administrative body is not subject to an audit by a national audit office in any of the Nordic countries, a state authorised or certified (registered) auditor must audit the annual report's financial statement. Audit instructions and the template for the audit declaration can be found at <https://www.norden.org/en/information/about-funding-nordic-council-ministers>

Annual report template

TO BE COMPLETED BY THE ADMINISTRATIVE BODY	TO BE COMPLETED BY THE SECRETARIAT TO THE NORDIC COUNCIL OF MINISTERS
Administrative body:	Project number in Unit4:
	DINA number:
	Budget item:
Project manager:	Advisor:

Activities 1

TO BE COMPLETED BY THE ADMINISTRATIVE BODY

OBJECTIVE	RESULT	BUDGET (+ ANY FUNDS BROUGHT FORWARDS FROM PREVIOUS YEARS)	SPENT FUNDS
		DKK XXX	%
COMMENTS ON ANY DEVIATIONS FROM THE BUDGET			
STATE WHICH OBJECTIVES OF OUR VISION 2030 THAT THE ACTIVITIES FOR THE YEAR HAVE CONTRIBUTED TO			
STATE 2+1 ^{*)}			
STATE ANY OTHER CROSS-SECTORAL PERSPECTIVES WHERE RELEVANT FOR THE SPECIFIC ACTIVITY (NORDIC ADVANTAGE, GENDER EQUALITY, SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT, CHILDREN AND YOUNG PEOPLE)			

**) 2+1 refers to the guideline that at least three Nordic countries, including the self-governing territories of Åland and Greenland, and the Faroe Islands, be included in each project funded by the Nordic Council of Ministers. Alternatively, this can be achieved through the involvement of at least two of the Nordic countries, including the self-governing territories and the Faroe Islands, and one non-Nordic country.*

Activities 2

TO BE COMPLETED BY THE ADMINISTRATIVE BODY

OBJECTIVE	RESULT	BUDGET (+ ANY FUNDS BROUGHT FORWARDS FROM PREVIOUS YEARS)	SPENT FUNDS
		DKK XXX	%
COMMENTS ON ANY DEVIATIONS FROM THE BUDGET			
STATE WHICH OBJECTIVES OF OUR VISION 2030 THAT THE ACTIVITIES FOR THE YEAR HAVE CONTRIBUTED TO			
STATE 2+1 ^{*)}			
STATE ANY OTHER CROSS-SECTORAL PERSPECTIVES WHERE RELEVANT FOR THE SPECIFIC ACTIVITY (NORDIC ADVANTAGE, GENDER EQUALITY, SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT, CHILDREN AND YOUNG PEOPLE)			

^{*)} 2+1 refers to the guideline that at least three Nordic countries, including the self-governing territories of Åland and Greenland, and the Faroe Islands, be included in each project funded by the Nordic Council of Ministers. Alternatively, this can be achieved through the involvement of at least two of the Nordic countries, including the self-governing territories and the Faroe Islands, and one non-Nordic country.

Financial statement for the Nordic Council of Ministers' funds in the annual report

(TO BE COMPLETED BY THE ADMINISTRATIVE BODY)

OPERATING INCOME (DKK)	BUDGET YEAR 202X
Funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers	
Unspent funds brought forwards from previous years	
Total income from Nordic Council of Ministers in 202X	
Operating expenses (DKK)	
Administrative expenses	
Other expenses	
Total expenses	
Total outcome	

(TO BE COMPLETED BY THE ADMINISTRATIVE BODY)

UNSPENT FUNDS FROM THE NORDIC COUNCIL OF MINISTERS (DKK) 2019 TO 2021			
Budgeted funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2019		Unspent funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2019	
Budgeted funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2020		Unspent funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2020	
Budgeted funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2021		Unspent funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers in 2021	
Total unspent funds from the Nordic Council of Ministers that the administrative body wishes to carry forwards to 2022			

Signatures

Operations manager
DD/MM/YYYY

Finance manager
DD/MM/YYYY